

Word family: **efficient / efficiently / efficiency / inefficient / inefficiency**

Base word: efficient

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **efficient** (adj.) — 有效率的；高效的；效能好的

* **efficiently** (adv.) — 有效率地；高效地

* **efficiency** (n.) — 效率；效能

* **inefficient** (adj.) — 效率低的；低效的

* **inefficiently** (adv.) — 低效率地

* **inefficiency** (n.) — 低效率；無效率

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **efficient worker**

* **efficient system**

* **efficient method**

* **efficient use of time**

* **efficient use of resources**

* **energy-efficient**

* **fuel-efficient**

* **cost-efficient / cost-effective**

* **operate efficiently**

* **improve efficiency**

* **increase efficiency**

* **maximum efficiency**

* **energy efficiency**

* **operational efficiency**

* **inefficient process**

Meaning in this passage

> Overall, this was a positive change because it did not just make me more **efficient**; it made me more stable, more disciplined, and frankly, much happier.

Here, **efficient** means:

able to complete work well without wasting unnecessary time or effort — 做事有效率的；能高效完成工作的

The speaker became better at organizing time, breaking tasks into steps, and avoiding last-minute panic.

****中文翻譯：****

總結來說，這是一個正面的改變，因為它不只是令我做事更****有效率****.....

So here:

**efficient = 能用較少浪費的時間、精力或資源，把事情做好**

1. **efficient (做事有效率的) — 有效率的；高效的**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The change made me more ****efficient****.

這個改變令我做事更****有效率****。

Practice 2

> She is an extremely ****efficient worker****.

她是一個非常****高效的員工****。

Practice 3

> Better planning makes me more ****efficient****.

更好的規劃令我做事更****有效率****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****efficient = 能在較少浪費時間、精力或資源的情況下把事情做好****

2. **efficient worker / person — 做事有效率的人**

Practice 1

> An ****efficient worker**** organizes tasks carefully.

一個****有效率的員工****會仔細安排任務。

Practice 2

> She is reliable, calm, and **efficient**.

她可靠、冷靜，而且**做事有效率**。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficient person = 能迅速而有條理地完成工作，並減少不必要浪費的人

3. **efficient system** — 高效系統；運作有效率的系統

Practice 1

> We need a more **efficient system** for handling requests.

我們需要一套更**高效的系統**處理要求。

Practice 2

> The new booking system is much more **efficient**.

新的預約系統**效率高得多**。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficient system = 能以較少時間、成本或資源完成所需功能的系統

4. **efficient method / process** — 高效方法 / 流程

Practice 1

> This is a more **efficient method** of organising files.

這是一種更**有效率的檔案整理方法**。

Practice 2

> The company introduced a more **efficient process**.

公司引入了一套更**高效的流程**。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficient method/process = 能減少浪費並以較好方式完成目的的方法或流程

5. **efficient use of time** — 有效率地運用時間

Very relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> A planner encourages more **efficient use of time**.

計劃本有助更**有效率地運用時間**。

Practice 2

> Good scheduling leads to the **efficient use of time**.

良好時間安排有助**善用時間**。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficient use of time = 把有限時間妥善安排，減少拖延和浪費

6. **efficient use of resources** — 有效率地運用資源

Practice 1

> The project requires the **efficient use of resources**.

項目需要**有效率地運用資源**。

Practice 2

> Good management ensures **efficient use of staff and equipment**.

良好管理可以確保**有效運用人手和設備**。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficient use of resources = 在減少浪費的同時充分利用資源

7. **operate / work efficiently** — 高效運作

Practice 1

> The team now **works more efficiently**.

團隊現在**工作效率更高**。

Practice 2

> The system can **operate efficiently** with fewer resources.

系統可以用較少資源**高效運作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

work/operate efficiently = 以較少浪費的時間、精力或資源完成工作

8. **efficiently** (有效率地) — 高效地 ; 有效率地

Practice 1

> She handles deadlines **efficiently**.

她**有效率地**處理截止日期。

Practice 2

> The office runs **efficiently**.

辦公室運作得很**有效率**。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficiently = 以高效率、少浪費的方式

9. **efficiency** (效率) — 效率 ; 效能

Practice 1

> Better planning improved my **efficiency**.

更好的規劃提升了我的**效率**。

Practice 2

> The company wants to increase **efficiency**.

公司希望提升**效率**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****efficiency = 完成工作時減少時間、精力、成本或資源浪費的程度****

10. ****improve / increase efficiency — 提升效率****

Practice 1

> Automation can ****improve efficiency****.

自動化可以****提升效率****。

Practice 2

> The new system was introduced to ****increase efficiency****.

新系統的引入是為了****提高效率****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****improve/increase efficiency = 令工作或系統能以更少浪費完成更多或更好的成果****

11. ****operational efficiency — 營運效率****

Practice 1

> The company is trying to improve ****operational efficiency****.

公司正努力改善****營運效率****。

Practice 2

> Better software increased ****operational efficiency****.

更好的軟件提升了****營運效率****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****operational efficiency = 機構在日常營運中有效運用時間、資源和成本的程度****

12. **energy efficiency — 能源效益；能源效率**

A major technical/environmental sense.

Practice 1

> The building has excellent **energy efficiency**.

這棟建築有很好的**能源效益**。

Practice 2

> Better insulation improves **energy efficiency**.

更好的隔熱可以提高**能源效率**。

MCQ-ready definition:

energy efficiency = 使用較少能源達到相同或更好效果的能力

13. **energy-efficient — 節能的；能源效益高的**

Practice 1

> We installed **energy-efficient lighting**.

我們安裝了**節能照明設備**。

Practice 2

> This appliance is more **energy-efficient**.

這部電器的**能源效益更高**。

MCQ-ready definition:

energy-efficient = 完成同樣功能時耗用較少能源的

14. **fuel-efficient — 省油的；燃油效益高的**

Practice 1

> This car is very **fuel-efficient**.

這輛車很**省油**。

Practice 2

> Many drivers prefer **fuel-efficient vehicles**.

很多司機較喜歡**燃油效益高的車輛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

fuel-efficient = 行駛相同距離時使用較少燃料的

15. **efficient machine / engine — 效能高的機器 / 引擎**

Practice 1

> The new engine is more **efficient**.

新引擎的**效能更高**。

Practice 2

> An **efficient machine** wastes less energy.

高效的機器浪費較少能源。

MCQ-ready definition:

efficient machine = 能把較大比例的輸入資源或能源轉化成有用輸出的機器

16. **efficiency (物理 / 工程 : 效率) — 效率 ; 能量轉換效率**

A distinct technical sense.

Practice 1

> The motor operates at ninety percent **efficiency**.

這個摩打以百分之九十的**效率**運作。

Practice 2

> Engineers measured the **efficiency of the engine**.

工程師量度了引擎的**效率**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****efficiency = 工程上有用輸出與總輸入之間的比例****

17. ****efficient cause — 動力因；作用因****

A specialist philosophical sense, especially in discussions of Aristotle.

Practice 1

> In classical philosophy, the builder may be described as the ****efficient cause**** of the house.

在古典哲學中，建造者可被稱為房屋的****動力因 / 作用因****。

Practice 2

> The term ****efficient cause**** has a technical philosophical meaning.

****efficient cause**** 在哲學中有專門含義。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****efficient cause = 哲學上令某件事實際產生或發生的作用者或原因****

This is established, but much lower priority for ordinary learners.

18. ****inefficient — 效率低的；浪費資源的****

Main opposite.

Practice 1

> The old system was slow and ****inefficient****.

舊系統又慢又****低效****。

Practice 2

> Constantly switching between tasks can be ****inefficient****.

不停在不同任務之間切換可能很****沒有效率****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****inefficient = 使用過多時間、精力或資源才能完成事情的****

19. ****inefficient worker / method — 做事低效的人 / 低效方法****

Practice 1

> The process is unnecessarily ****inefficient****.

這個流程不必要地****低效****。

Practice 2

> Poor organization made my study habits ****inefficient****.

組織不善令我的學習習慣變得****效率很低****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****inefficient = 有很多不必要浪費，因此不能有效完成工作的****

20. ****inefficiency — 低效率；無效率****

Practice 1

> Poor communication created ****inefficiency****.

溝通不良造成了****低效率****。

Practice 2

> The company wants to reduce ****inefficiencies****.

公司希望減少各種****低效環節****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****inefficiency = 時間、資源或工作流程存在不必要浪費的狀態****

21. ****inefficiencies (低效環節；浪費) — 低效之處****

Plural often refers to specific flaws in a process.

Practice 1

> The review identified several **inefficiencies** in the system.

檢討發現系統中有數個**低效環節**。

Practice 2

> Automation removed many administrative **inefficiencies**.

自動化消除了很多行政流程上的**低效問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

inefficiencies = 流程中個別造成時間、成本或資源浪費的地方

Important distinction 1: **efficient** vs **effective**

This is the most important distinction.

effective

achieves the desired result.

efficient

achieves the result with little waste.

Example:

> A method can be effective but inefficient.

一個方法可以**有效**，但很**沒有效率**。

Suppose you finish an assignment correctly after working for 20 unnecessary hours:

* **effective** → yes, you completed it.

* **efficient** → probably not.

Important distinction 2: **efficient** vs **productive**

efficient

little waste relative to output.

productive

produces a lot of useful work/results.

You can be productive but inefficient by getting lots done while wasting unnecessary time.

Important distinction 3: **efficient vs fast**

fast

quick.

efficient

uses time/resources well.

A fast method can still be inefficient if it wastes materials or causes errors.

So:

efficient ≠ merely fast

Important distinction 4: **efficient vs organised**

organised

things are arranged clearly and systematically.

efficient

the arrangement helps you complete things with little waste.

Being organized often improves efficiency, but they are not identical.

Your passage actually shows the relationship:

> become organised → manage tasks better → become more efficient

Important distinction 5: **efficient vs reliable**

efficient

uses resources well.

reliable

can be depended on consistently.

A machine can be:

- * very reliable but energy-inefficient,
- * very efficient but prone to breakdowns.

Different dimensions.

Important distinction 6: **efficient vs economical**

efficient

minimizes waste broadly.

economical

especially saves money or resources.

> efficient workflow

> 高效工作流程

> economical car

> 使用成本低 / 省油的車

Important distinction 7: **efficient vs cost-effective**

efficient

good use of resources.

cost-effective

produces worthwhile results relative specifically to financial cost.

A method may be efficient in time but expensive, so not necessarily cost-effective.

Important distinction 8: **efficient vs energy-efficient**

efficient

general.

energy-efficient

specifically minimizes energy use.

> efficient employee

> 高效員工

> energy-efficient fridge

> 節能雪櫃

Important distinction 9: **efficiency vs productivity**

efficiency

ratio between useful result and resources used.

productivity

amount of output produced.

Increasing productivity can sometimes reduce efficiency if it requires disproportionate extra resources.

Important distinction 10: **efficiency vs efficacy**

Especially in technical/medical contexts:

efficiency

resource use.

efficacy

whether something can produce the intended effect under specified conditions.

They sound similar but are different words.

Important distinction 11: **efficient person**

Calling a person **efficient** usually praises **how they work**, not necessarily their intelligence or creativity.

> She's efficient.

usually means:

- * organized,
- * quick enough,
- * little wasted effort,
- * gets things done smoothly.

Important distinction 12: **efficiency in engineering**

Everyday:

> efficiency = 工作效率

Engineering:

> efficiency = useful output ÷ total input

The technical sense is more mathematically precise.

Important distinction 13: **inefficient vs ineffective**

inefficient

gets the result but wastes too much.

ineffective

does not successfully produce the result.

Example:

> The process works, but takes twice as long as necessary.

> → ****inefficient****

> The process doesn't solve the problem at all.

> → ****ineffective****

Excellent MCQ distinction.

Important distinction 14: ****inefficiency vs waste****

****waste****

the unnecessary loss/use itself.

****inefficiency****

a system or process state that produces such waste.

> wasted time

> 浪費的時間

> process inefficiency

> 流程低效

Important distinction 15: ****more efficient in your passage****

The speaker does not merely mean:

> "I work faster now."

It means:

****I manage my time and workload better, waste less effort on panic and last-minute rushing, and complete responsibilities more smoothly.****

That broader meaning is important.

Family-extension note

****Efficient**** has one strong semantic core:

**produce the desired output while minimizing unnecessary use of time, energy, money, or other resources**

That branches into:

1. **people/work**

- * efficient worker
- * work efficiently

2. **systems/processes**

- * efficient system
- * efficient method

3. **resource management**

- * efficient use of time
- * efficient use of resources

4. **business**

- * operational efficiency

5. **energy/environment**

- * energy-efficient
- * fuel-efficient

6. **engineering**

- * machine efficiency
- * energy conversion efficiency

7. **negative family**

- * inefficient
- * inefficiency

8. **specialist philosophical sense**

* efficient cause

For your passage, the exact branch is:

efficient = able to get work done well with less wasted time and effort

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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efficient	有效率的；高效的	little waste	
efficient worker	高效的員工	effective work with little waste	
efficient system	高效系統	smooth resource use	
efficient method	高效方法	efficient process	
efficient use of time	有效率運用時間	time management	
efficient use of resources	有效運用資源	minimize waste	
efficiently	有效率地	manner	
efficiency	效率	degree of efficient use	
improve efficiency	提升效率	reduce waste	
operational efficiency	營運效率	organization	
energy efficiency	能源效率	energy use	
energy-efficient	節能的	low energy use	
fuel-efficient	省油的	low fuel use	
efficient machine	效能高的機器	useful output	
efficiency (engineering)	能量轉換效率	output/input	
efficient cause	動力因；作用因	philosophy	
inefficient	低效的	excessive waste	
inefficiency	低效率	wasteful operation	
inefficiencies	低效環節	specific process flaws	

For your original sentence

> Overall, this was a positive change because it did not just make me more **efficient**; it made me more stable, more disciplined, and frankly, much happier.

Here:

efficient = 我不再經常拖到最後一刻才趕工，而是能更有條理地運用時間和精力，把事情順利完成

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 這是一個正面的改變，因為它不只是令我做事更**有效率**；它也令我變得更穩定、更自律，而且更快樂。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **effective** = **做到目標**

> **efficient** = **做到目標，而且少浪費時間 / 精力 / 資源**

> **productive** = **產出很多成果**

> **organised** = **安排有條理**

For this passage, **efficient** specifically captures the shift from **last-minute panic and wasted effort** to **smooth, well-managed work**.